

Rafi Ali

UX/Product Designer

Case Studies

2025 - Present

Role

Product Designer

Islamicly

Designed a 41-page Islamic learning platform across 3 units, architecting the system and design system together so the interface maps directly onto a complex backend. Built a scholar review pipeline that routes every page past 2 scholars before publication; balancing religious sacredness against modern interface conventions drove most design decisions.

2026

Role

Lead Researcher - Author

Justice Is a Right

Led research and design for a VR experience linking food access to crime patterns in underserved communities, directing a four-person interdisciplinary team. Wrote 9 pages of research and the 6-page poster accepted to ACM COMPASS 2026 as primary author, and earned the Open Project Developer Level II badge from IBM.

2025

Role

Researcher - UX Designer

Light to the Artists

Interviewed artists at the Chicago Art Department to design an exhibition poster system, and found they wanted control over which works represented them. Reshaped it into 3 posters matching color and tone to each artist's style, paired with their own words; exhibited at CAD and presented to a room of 40 peers, faculty, and stakeholders.

2026 - Present

Role

Designer - Engineer

Clarity

Designed and shipped a zakat calculator with a guided flow that asks one question at a time across 4 asset categories, built to prevent the omissions that make self-calculation unreliable. Wrote the TypeScript front end and Claude API integration myself, with ~100 test cases covering calculation edge cases.

Work

2025 - Present

Location

Skokie, Illinois

Founded Lantern Software

A tech company building learning tools for Muslim communities; designed and shipped Islamicly and Clarity. Directs 30% of revenue to water and food infrastructure in underserved regions.

2021 - 2024

Location

SD69 - Skokie, Illinois

Summer Program Teacher

Education

2023 - 2027

Location

University of Illinois Chicago

B.S Computer Science + Digital Design

Skills

Technical	Design
Figma, Illustrator, InDesign	Interface Design Wireframing & Prototyping
JS, Next.js, TS, HTML, CSS, Python, C++, C, Swift	Visual Design Design focused research

Find me

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/rafi-ali-design](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rafi-ali-design)

Lantern Software: lanternsoftware.vercel.app